Mining

☞ **1** Circle the correctly spelled word in each pair.

Only a few metals are found in a pure form in nature/nautre. Most of the metals we use come from minerals/minirals or **ores** found in the ground. Most ores are **oxides** of metals. That means that the metal is combined with oxegen/oxygen. Once these ores have been mined/mineded, the metals need to be extracted/extraced from them. The method of mining used depends on the size, shape and debth/depth of the ore body.

2 The two methods of mining are open-cut (O) and underground (U). Decide which method each sentence describes and label each one.

_____ Used when ore is close to the surface

_____ Big hole in the ground

_____ Used when ore body lies deep beneath the earth

_____ Used when ore body is narrow and at a steep angle

_____ Leaves less scars on the surface of earth

_____ Dug in steps or levels to reach the area to be mined

_____ More cost effective

_____ Tunnels or shafts are built

_____ Steps include roads. As more material is removed, new steps are built

_____ More dangerous and expensive than open-cut mining

3 Complete the table below about metals commonly mined in Australia.

Metal	Name of ore	Formula	Elements present
	bauxite	Al_2O_3	1. Aluminium 2.
	haematite	Fe_2O_3	1. 2. Oxygen
	galena	PbS	1. 2.
	gold	Au	1.

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